Sungbin Park

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(Updated November 2026)

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate in Public Policy (ABD), Schar School of Policy and Government, George Mason University, VA — 2021–May 2027 (Expected)

M.A. in Behavioral Socioeconomics, Ewha Womans University, Seoul — 2017–2019

B.A. in Social Science Education, International Office Administration (Double Major), Ewha Womans University (*summa cum laude*) — 2012–2017

RESEARCH FIELDS

Labor economics, health economics, public policy, applied microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Forced to Choose? Unemployment Insurance Versus Health Insurance

- **Abstract**: Medicaid eligibility rules may force some workers to choose between unemployment insurance (UI) benefits and health insurance coverage. Because Medicaid eligibility is based on income including UI benefits, some workers face a notch in loss of coverage if they claim UI. Exploiting the state-time varying ACA Medicaid expansions, I focus on childless adults within the "notched" group and analyze UI and Medicaid take-up using the 2008–2019 Survey of Income and Program Participation. I find UI take-up falls by 19.6 percentage points among notched workers, 27 percent of their pre-expansion rate, while the comparison group, whose UI benefits do not increase income above the Medicaid eligibility threshold, shows little change in UI take-up. I estimate that among those forgoing UI, the average revealed willingness to pay for Medicaid is at least $353 per week.
- **Presentations:** National Tax Association (NTA, planned), Center for Micro-Economic Policy Research (CMEPR), Washington Area Meeting of Economic Scientists (WAMES), Washington Area Labor Economics Symposium (WALES), Labor and Employment Relations Association (LERA), American Society of Health Economists (ASHE)

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Park, S.**, Lee, K.M., & Earle, J.S. (2026). Premature termination of unemployment benefits increased COVID-19 transmission and deaths in the USA. *Nature Human Behaviour, 10*: 1094-1108 [5-Year 2024 IF: 19.7].
- Abouk, R., Earle, J.S., Maclean, J.C., & **Park, S.** (2025). Promoting public health with blunt instruments: Evidence from vaccine mandates. *Labour Economics*, 96, 102715.
- Kim, I., **Park, S.**, & Choi, M. (2024). Educational Tourism and School Trips: Smart Applications to Facilitate Field Trips in South Korea. *Journal of Research in Curriculum and Instruction, 28*(5): 358-367.
- Kim, I., **Park, S.**, & Choi, M. (2019). Design and Application of Korean Economic History Education Program Using Project-Based Learning. *Korean Journal of Economic Education, 26* (1): 91-115. (in Korean)
- Jeon, E.J., **Park, S.**, & Choi, M. (2017). Time Preference and Economic Decision Making in Aging: Focusing on Implications for Economics Education. *Journal of Research in Curriculum and Instruction, 21* (5): 564-576. (in Korean)

WORKING PAPERS

- "The Racial Mortality Gap and Unemployment Insurance Cuts during the Covid Pandemic" (with J.S. Earle). *Under review*.

- Won the Best Poster Award at Society of Labor Economists (6th World Labor Conference) 2025.

- "Adverse Shocks, Windfalls, and Innovation" (with K.M. Lee, L. Dani, J.S. Earle, Y. Kim). *Under review.*
- "Opioid Prescription Duration Limit and Polysubstance Treatment Admissions in Publicly Funded Facilities" (with C. Jeung, K.M. Lee).
- "Death Without Benefits: Unemployment Insurance, Re-Employment, and the Spread of Covid" (with J.S. Earle and K.M. Lee). The University of Chicago Stone Center Working Paper Series, 24-02, 2024.
  - Won the IPUMS CPS Research Award 2023.

Selected Work in Progress

- "Breaking Barriers? Occupational Licensure Compacts and Physician Mobility"
- "How Contingent are Contingent Workers? Evidence from Short-Run Labor Adjustments during the COVID Pandemic" (with L. Dani, J.S. Earle, K.M. Lee)
- "Was Obamacare a Job Killer? Firm-Level Evidence on the ACA Employer Mandate" (with J. Wold, J.S. Earle, K.M. Lee)
- "Reassessing the Effects of In-Person vs. Remote Schooling on Covid Outcomes" (with J.S. Earle, J.M. Gonzales)

Research Experience

Special Sworn Status (SSS) Researcher, U.S. Census Bureau 2025–Present

Research Assistant (to Prof. John Earle), George Mason University 2021–Present

Research Assistant (to Prof. Minsik Choi), Ewha Womans University 2017–2019

Teaching Fields

Labor economics, health economics, public policy, applied econometrics, program evaluation, microeconomics for policy analysis

Teaching Experience

Math Camp Instructor

Economics Math Workshop (PUBP 555) 2023–2026

Stata Session Instructor

Multivariate Statistical Analysis in Public Policy (PUBP 804, Prof. John Earle) Spring 2024–2026

Introductory Data Analysis for Policy and Government (POGO 511, Prof. John Earle) Fall 2025–2026

Teaching Assistant

Advanced Micro-Economic Analysis for Policy Research (PUBP 792, Prof. John Earle) Fall 2026

Labor Markets and Policies (PUBP 732, Prof. John Earle) Spring 2026

Introduction to Econometrics (ECON 345, Prof. Thomas Stratmann) Summer 2025

Work Experience

Researcher, Korea Institute for Industrial Economics & Trade (KIET), Sejong, Korea 2020–2021

Government-funded research institute. Research projects:

- "2020 Korean Industry: Focusing on the Value Chain Analysis of Major Industries and Sources of Competitive Advantage"
- "Establishment of a Value Chain-Based Industrial Competitiveness Diagnosis System"

Selected Presentations

† =poster

2026 Center for Micro-Economic Policy Research (CMEPR), Washington Area Meeting of Economic Scientists (WAMES)†, Washington Area Labor Economics Symposium (WALES)†, Labor and Employment Relations Association (LERA), Society of Labor Economists

(SOLE)†, American Society of Health Economists (ASHE), National Tax Association (NTA)

2025 American Society of Health Economists (ASHE), World Labor Conference (SOLE with AASLE and EALE)†, ASSA Annual Meeting, Society of Government Economists (SGE)

2024 Washington Area Labor Economics Symposium (WALES)†, Johns Hopkins SAIS, Comparative Analysis of Enterprise Data (CAED), UChicago Stone Center Conference and Summer School on Socioeconomic Opportunity and Inequality†, Southern Economic Association (SEA)

2023 Washington Area Labor Economics Symposium (WALES)†, IPUMS Data-Intensive Research Conference, International Economic Association (IEA)

Honors & Scholarships

Summer Research Assistantship, Office of the Provost at GMU — 2026

Outstanding PhD Student Publication Award (Co-Authored) for Park, Lee, & Earle (2026) — 2026
Schar School of Policy and Government, GMU

Best Poster Award, Society of Labor Economists (6th World Labor Conference) — 2025

IPUMS CPS Research Award 2023 — 2024

Graduate Student Award, Southern Economic Association — 2024

Pass with Distinction (Qualifying Exam Part 1 - Quantitative) — 2023

Schar School Student Research Grant, George Mason University — 2021–2026

Presidential Scholarship, Office of the Provost at GMU — 2021–2025

Research Report Award, Korea Institute for Industrial Economics & Trade — August 2021
- Excellent Research Report Award, Excellent Granted Research Report Award

Admissions and Honors Scholarship, Ewha Womans University — 2012–2017
- Admissions Scholarships (2012, 2017)
- Honors Scholarships (2012-2016)
- Dean's List (2012-2015)

Service

Assistant Director, Center for Micro-Economic Policy Research (CMEPR) — 2023–Present
- Weekly Micro-Economic Policy Seminar (MEPS) and
  2025 Washington Are Labor Economics Symposium (WALES)

President, Schar PhD Student Association (SPSA) — 2024–2025

Secretary, Schar PhD Student Association (SPSA) — 2023–2024

Skills & Languages

Software Stata, R, Python, LaTeX

Languages English (fluent), Korean (native)

References

Dr. John S. Earle
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